

What is encapsulation and why is it important?

Encapsulation is an 'object-oriented' programming practice. It is a very clever technique for managing data in a class and protecting access to important variables. In the recent scripture memorizer assignment, I made my `_text` and `_isHidden` variables private and made public methods for my other classes to use them. This is a good practice that prevents programming mistakes. It would be very easy to accidentally set my `_isHidden` variable to an incorrect value and bug up my program. This makes almost any program easier to maintain or revisit after a long while and not need major changes.